STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-6500
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED 08/13/07	DATE REVISED **07/28/21**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL: K-9 UNIT	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT K-9 UNIT SELECTION AND TRAINING		CROSS REFERENCE G-5230 TRANSFER AND ASSIGNMENT		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for the selection and training of K-9 handlers and K-9 teams.

II. Policy:

K-9 handlers shall be chosen from the ranks of sworn Sarpy County Sheriff's deputies. In an attempt to recruit the most qualified deputies for the position, the Sheriff's Office shall set minimum standards for K-9 handlers. After selection (see G-5230 Transfer and Assignment), K-9 handlers shall be required to successfully complete training with his or her assigned K-9. K-9 teams shall also complete on-going training and certification.

III. Procedure:

A. Minimum Requirements for K-9 Handler: Prospective K-9 handlers must meet all of the following requirements:

1. Be a deputy with a minimum of two (2) years of experience.
2. Reside within twenty (20) minutes response time of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office under normal driving conditions.
3. Be physically and mentally capable of performing the duties of a K-9 handler.
4. Have a background with animals and the ability to properly care for a K-9.
5. Show an earnest desire to work as part of a K-9 team.
6. Have a recommendation from his or her current supervisor.
7. Expect to function as a K-9 handler for a minimum of four (4) years.
8. Willing to allow an in-home interview by the selection committee.
9. Have demonstrated an ability to meet performance standards in his or her current assignment (as reflected in his or her performance evaluations).

B. Selection of K-9s:

1. A reputable vendor will be selected to assist with the procurement of any new K-9.

2. The potential handler and/or K-9 Unit Commander will meet with the vendor to discuss the K-9 qualities desired.

C. Training of K-9 Teams:

1. Selected handlers shall complete a state certified basic training program provided by the Nebraska State Patrol, Omaha Police Department or Bellevue Police Department. This program must be completed to certify the handler and K-9 as a K-9 team and shall be completed prior to any operational use. A K-9 team shall only be used for tasks for which the team has received certification. Certification shall be based upon a formal performance test conducted by a state certified evaluator or judge in law enforcement canine trainer with expertise in judging law enforcement canine teams.

2. A handler may participate in a shorter duration training program if the prospective handler has received prior approved training. The length of training shall be determined by the proficiency of the K-9 team. Certification shall still be based on a formal performance test conducted by a state certified evaluator or judge.

3. All training shall be in accordance with standards established by the Sheriff.

4. K-9 teams shall participate in regular training to maintain skills and certification.

5. K-9 teams shall be required to complete recertification on an annual basis to demonstrate continued proficiency. A K-9 team shall only be used for those tasks where the team has completed recertification.

6. All K-9 team training shall be documented on a K-9 Team Training form. The original training form shall be maintained by the K-9 Unit Commander. The K-9 handler may retain copies for his or her own records.